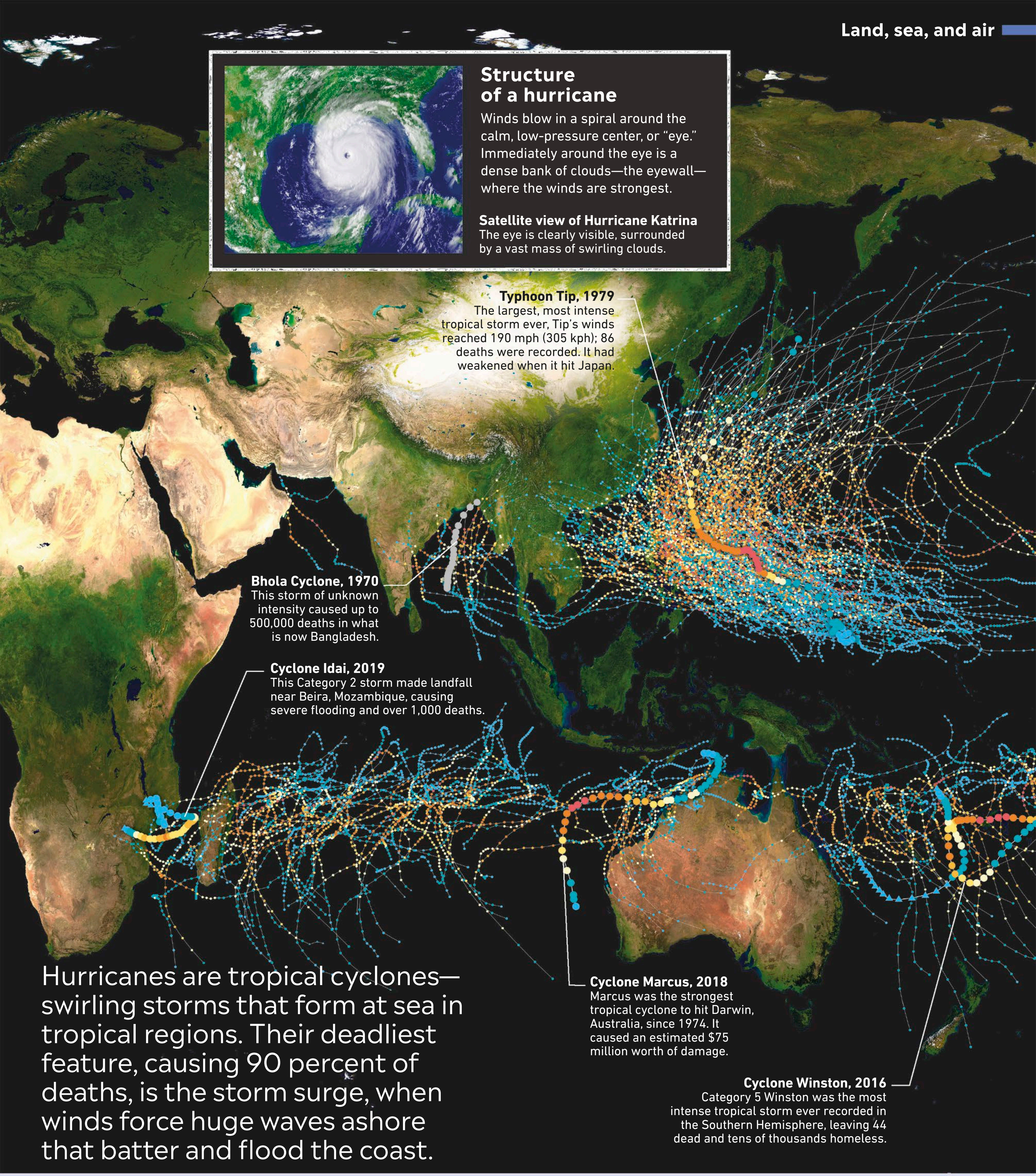

Structure of a hurricane

Winds blow in a spiral around the calm, low-pressure center, or "eye." Immediately around the eye is a dense bank of clouds—the eyewall—where the winds are strongest.

Satellite view of Hurricane Katrina
The eye is clearly visible, surrounded by a vast mass of swirling clouds.

Hurricanes are tropical cyclones—swirling storms that form at sea in tropical regions. Their deadliest feature, causing 90 percent of deaths, is the storm surge, when winds force huge waves ashore that batter and flood the coast.

HEMISPHERE, BUT CLOCKWISE IN THE SOUTHERN HEMISPHERE.